Teach Yourself JAVA in 21 Days

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About This Book

This book teaches you all about the Java language and how to use it to create applets and applications. By the time you get through with this book, you'll know enough about Java to do just about anything, inside an applet or out.

Who Should Read This Book

This book is intended for people with at least some basic programming background, which includes people with years of programming experience or people with only a small amount of experience. If you understand what variables, loops, and functions are, you'll be just fine for this book. The sorts of people who might want to read this book include you, if

- ☐ You're a real whiz at HTML, understand CGI programming (in perl, AppleScript, Visual Basic, or some other popular CGI language) pretty well, and want to move on to the next level in Web page design.
- ☐ You had some Basic or Pascal in school and you have a basic grasp of what programming is, but you've heard Java is easy to learn, really powerful, and very cool.
- ☐ You've programmed C and C++ for many years, you've heard this Java thing is becoming really popular and you're wondering what all the fuss is all about.
- ☐ You've heard that Java is really good for Web-based applets, and you're curious about how good it is for creating more general applications.

What if you know programming, but you don't know object-oriented programming? Fear not. This book assumes no background in object-oriented design. If you know object-oriented programming, in fact, the first couple of days will be easy for you.

How This Book Is Structured

This book is intended to be read and absorbed over the course of three weeks. During each week, you'll read seven chapters that present concepts related to the Java language and the creation of applets and applications.

Conventions

Note: A Note box presents interesting pieces of information related to the surrounding discussion.

Technical Note: A Technical Note presents specific technical information related to the surrounding discussion.

Tip: A Tip box offers advice or teaches an easier way to do something.

Caution: A Caution box alerts you to a possible problem and gives you advice to avoid it.

Warning: A Warning box advises you about potential problems and helps you steer clear of disaster.

NEW TERM New terms are introduced in New Term boxes, with the term in italics.

Type A type icon identifies some new HTML code that you can type in yourself.

Output An Output icon highlights what the same HTML code looks like when viewed by either Netscape or Mosaic.

Analysis An analysis icon alerts you to the author's line-by-line analysis.

To Eric, for all the usual reasons
(moral support, stupid questions, comfort in dark times).
LL

For RKJP, ARL, and NMH
the three most important people in my life.
CLP

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